

Analytics Hardening — Dub Features & the Rainbow Run Plan

Engine · TeX backend

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1 The model — three layers, each doing its best job

Layer	Job	Owns
Dub	top-of-funnel attribution — which <i>short</i> drove a click	link clicks, device/geo of clickers, <code>utm_*</code> + <code>dub_id</code>
PostHog	the funnel + retention (play → engage → return)	<code>game_open</code> → <code>level_start</code> → <code>level_complete</code> , cohorts, drill-in
Hub <code>/api/track</code>	server-side truth (ad-blocker-proof) + eval signal	death heatmaps, completion/pacing, difficulty calibration

Key idea: Dub passes `utm_content` (the short id) + `dub_id` into the game; the game threads them into **PostHog** event/person properties, so every funnel and retention chart can be broken down by *which short* the player came from. PostHog is the funnel; Dub is the attribution that feeds it.

2 Dub features — how you’d actually use each

For your case: 16 free browser games, plays driven by short-form video.

Feature	Tier	What it is	How you use it	Prio.
Conversion tracking	Free*/Pro	ties a click to downstream events (play, complete)	attribute <i>plays & completions</i> to a short, not just clicks	High
50K events/mo	Pro	conversion-event volume cap	16 games of real plays blow past Free's low cap	High
1-year retention	Pro	data kept 365d (Free $\approx$ 30d)	you need <i>months</i> to see which shorts retain	High
Advanced analytics	Pro	device/geo/browser/referrer breakdown	know <i>who & where</i> plays come from	High
UTM builder	Pro	standardize utm_* + templates	clean funnel data across every short	High
Custom domain	Free/Pro	branded go.funstackstudios.com/x	trust + CTR + first-party	Med
Device targeting	Pro	route iOS/Android/desktop differently	send mobile to a touch-tuned entry	Med
Tags / Folders	Pro	organize links	one folder per game, tags per platform	Med
Custom previews	Pro	OG card when a link is shared	branded preview in DMs/X	Med
Custom QR codes	Pro	branded QR per link	QR end-card in a short / IRL	Low
A/B testing	Business	two destinations, winner by conversions	test variants once volume justifies	Later
Geo targeting	Pro	region-specific destinations	only once you localize	Later
Deep links	Pro	open a mobile <i>app</i> from a link	N/A — web-only, no app	—
Cloaking / expiry / password	Pro	hide / time-box / gate a link	no reason to hide the play URL	—

*Conversion tracking *works* on Free, but with a low event cap, basic analytics, and $\approx$ 30-day retention. Pro's value is **volume + depth + retention**.

3 Verdict on upgrading

Free-first: wire the full click $\rightarrow$ play $\rightarrow$ complete funnel and validate it end-to-end on Free. **Upgrade to Pro (\$30/mo)** when you hit the event cap or want 1-year retention + advanced breakdowns + a branded short domain — i.e. once the funnel is proven and running for real across games. A/B testing is a *Business*-tier feature, not Pro — don't upgrade for it yet.

4 What “hardened” Rainbow Run analytics looks like

Attribution threading: Dub link $\rightarrow$ `/go/rainbow-run?utm_*` (Dub appends `dub_id`) $\rightarrow$ game. The game reads `utm_source/medium/content + dub_id` on load and attaches them to *every* PostHog event + the hub `/api/track` payload.

Event	When	Key props
game_open	first load	utm_source/medium/ content (short id), dub_id, device
level_start	each biome (re)load	level, biome
checkpoint	mid-level checkpoint	level, x
coin_collect	pickup	level, coins, x, y
player_death	death	level, biome, cause (fall/hazard), x, y, t_ms
level_complete	win	level, duration_ms, deaths, coins
weather_shift	biome weather change (RR's hook)	level, weather
game_complete	final level done	total_time, total_deaths
player_idle / quit	disengage	level, x, ms

PostHog funnels you'll get: pageview → game_open → level_start → level_complete, broken down by utm_content (which short converts best), plus retention by short. **Dub** shows clicks → conversions per short. **Hub /api/funnel** is the ad-blocker-proof reconciliation + feeds the game-design eval.

The one blocker: editing the game needs write access to agadabanka/rainbow-run, which isn't in this session's scope. Add it: Claude Code web → this environment → Settings → Repository Scope → add agadabanka/rainbow-run. Then everything above ships in one pass.